

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ K

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 2 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣ 3

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥ 5

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5
♥ K Q 9 4 2
♦ A 10 9
♣ J 5 2

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4



♠ 6 3
♥ A J 10 3
♦ K Q J 6
♣ 10 6 3

♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7

NORTH's 3♥ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand, (and particularly the singleton ♥), makes it worth a raise to game.

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10
♥ A 9 7 5 4
♦ K Q 6 2
♣ 9 6

♠ 4 2

♥ J 8 3 2

♦ A 5

♣ 8 7 5 4 2



♠ A J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A J 10 3

♠ Q 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 10

♦ J 10 9 3

♣ K Q

EAST has no reason to consider Fourth Suit Forcing with this hand.

WEST does not have four ♠s or he would have already supported.

So EAST should bid the Notrump game.

West

1 ♥

North

Pass

East

1 ♠

South

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣K

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 6 4

♥ 5 4

♦ A 10 5 2

♣ Q 8 3

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2



♠ Q 9 5 2

♥ K J

♦ J 9 3

♣ K J 5 4

♠ A 7

♥ Q 10 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A 10 9 6

SOUTH should pass 2♥. She is not strong enough to try for game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by South

Lead: ♣3

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ A 10 7
 ♦ Q 10 6 4 3
 ♣ A K 2

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 5 3

♦ K J 8

♣ J 10 5 4



♠ K Q 10 6 3
 ♥ K Q J 8
 ♦ 9 5
 ♣ Q 8

♠ J 7

♥ 9 6 4 2

♦ A 7 2

♣ 9 7 6 3

EAST knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠, 4♥ or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and bids 2♣ at her second turn.

WEST does not have a 4-card ♥ suit, nor does he have three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which East raises to 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥5			